

Tutor/Mentor Connection

Central Database and Infrastructure System Project Initiation Report

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1	Initial Report	July 29, 2002	Initial version of document.
2	Cost/Benefits Analysis	Aug 02, 2002	Use Business case calculator to compute cost/benefit.

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Table of Contents

1. INTRODUCTION	9
1.1 Purpose	9
1.2 Document Organization	9
1.3 Project Background	9
1.4 Options Summary	10
2. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	11
2.1 Requirements/Scope Summary	11
2.2 Constraints/Issues	12
2.3 Recommendation	12
3. PROJECT ORGANIZATION	13
3.1 Assigning Resources	13
3.2 Project Organization Chart	15
4. SCHEDULES AND BUDGET	16
4.1 Schedules	16
4.2.1 Assumptions	17
4.2 Overall Project Cost Analysis and Cost Curve	17
4.3 Project Budget	17
6. BUSINESS CASE	18
6.1 Project Description	18
6.2 Benefit Analysis	18
6.3 Cost/Benefit Analysis	19
APPENDIX A - COMMUNICATION/TRAINING PLAN	20
A.1 Communication Plan	20
A.2 Training Plan	20
APPENDIX B - ISSUES MANAGEMENT	21
B.1 Issue Tracking	21
B.2 Issue Tracking System	21

APPENDIX C - CHANGE MANAGEMENT PROCESS	23
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C.1 Overview and Objectives	23
C.2 Tool	23
C.3 Process	23

APPENDIX D - QUALITY MANAGEMENT APPROACH	24
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D.1 Planned Activities	24
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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this Initiation Report is to document the high-level requirements of the Central Database Infrastructure System (CDIS) for Tutor/Mentor Connection learning network. Its purpose is to provide sufficient information to enable CDIS team to decide whether to proceed to next phase of the project. The information included on this report consist of:

- A clearly defined project scope.
- Lists of key representatives of the project.
- Project and quality control procedures to be implemented.
- Documentation of business case for the project:
 - Cost/Benefit and Risk Analysis.
 - Budget for the Project.
- Recommended course of action.
- A plan for the next stage which consists of:
 - Schedule of activities for the next stage.
 - Resource allocation with cost breakdown.

After reviewing the document, the Project Board may recommend some changes to the plan. These changes will be reflected in an updated Project Initiation Report or as an amendment to the Project Initiation Report to ensure accurate communication of the plan to all team members.

1.2 Document Organization

Section 1 Introduction provides generic information regarding the items included in the Initiation report. It includes a succinct description of the current scenario and existing systems and the concerns with these systems. It also includes the Options as possible business solutions.

Section 2 Executive Summary provides an overview of key project points and high level recommendations for the project.

The rest of the document supports the Executive Summary section by providing the detailed information and analytical charts upon which the Executive Summary was based.

1.3 Project Background/Business Case:

Tutor/Mentor Connections, a program started at Cabrini Connections enterprise, aims to gather and organize all that is known about successful non-school tutor/mentor programs and to share that knowledge to expand the availability of these services to children in inner city Chicago and poverty areas. This mission is accomplishing its goal as follows:

- Increasing knowledge about what works, where programs are located and where more are needed.
- Aggressively sharing this knowledge in marketing and public awareness campaigns aimed at:
 - creating greater involvement for all adults, and greater flow of essential resources to individual programs and,
 - better understanding among all stakeholders of the long-term, integrated actions needed to help children and youth move from birth in poverty to jobs and a career. For each child this is a minimum 25-year commitment.

Currently, there are 6 major independent functional areas within the TMC network, that support its activity:

*Kids Connection Student/Volunteer Participation History -
per inventory excel - provides evaluation for management use
The Survey -*

- TMC Contact History, a database of individuals and organizations that are involved with tutor-mentor programs.
- TMC Survey connection assembles program information through survey forms distributed to organizations that support related work. This consists of location, contact and a description of the program. Additionally, the surveys bring back feedback information about the program on type (non-school or school), age group it serves, volunteer profile and availability.
- TMC Kids Connection captures student and volunteer demographics, enrollment, participation and grade history on Excel spreadsheets. It surveys more than 300 other locations annually (using a paper based survey) to collect this information from each program and organizes it by zip code, time of day service is provided, age group served, etc.
- TMC GIS support connection creates GIS maps, visually illustrating captured demographics at regional level.
- TMC OHATS (Organizational History and Accomplishment Tracking System) connection, an Internet-based system to easily record and report important events, actions and lessons that take place during the day-to-day work to improve the conditions necessary for all youth to succeed.
- TMC Conferences connection, a system designed to support organization of conferences, leadership, philanthropic participation, learning workshops and information sharing among major stakeholders.

TMC Gear Systems Surveys

Additionally, there are numerous independent activities within the network, like fundraising & benefit events, recruitment campaigns, email marketing, newsletters and a large web presence. These activities support the day-to-day functions of the TMC network along with propagating its message, goals and philosophies to general public. Upon review of these functional areas it was evident that some of them have technical limitations that either need to be enhanced or re-engineered. Those are:

- TMC Contact History is maintained in a Macintosh FileMakerPro database with single user access. Lack of volunteers who are skillful in FileMaker software warrants it to be migrated to a newer 'mainstream' database. Also, there is a need to access and update this database with multiple users.
- TMC Kids Connection demographics and history is largely organized on Excel Spreadsheets. Difficult to pull reports on history of participation and grades. Spreadsheets lack infrastructure to perform complex queries on them for further data analysis.
- Manual intervention is required to export data from Contact History to GIS support to enable map creation.
- TMC Conference connection database lacks tracking of participation history of leaders and key participants in conferences.
- Duplicate data entry in multiple data collection pools may be prone to translation errors. Also, difficult to keep track.
- Email marketing database is neither scalable nor searchable.

It is evident that some of current existing systems cannot satisfy many of TMC network's growing needs. To enhance these systems to meet current and future needs requires significant re-engineering. An enterprise application that meets TMC's needs as a whole is clearly needed to improve accuracy, streamlining key processes, and meet future business growth.

1.4 Options Summary

To determine the appropriate technical solution, these options should be discussed, reviewed and explored by the Project Board of TMC:

- Develop a webbased Central Database Infrastructure System.
- Develop a webbased Distributed Database Infrastructure System?
- Vendor Solution?

2. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

2.1 Requirements/Scope Summary

The project entails the delivery of an enterprise system that meets the current and future TMC requirements. This would be in the form of a web based system that will support the mission of TMC. Such a system would allow all stakeholders of TMC network to connect in an information gathering, analysis and sharing platform.

Current project requirements can be summarized as follows:

1. Provide a centralized ISP hosted database to capture and maintain Program Information data.
 - Migrate FileMakerPro Contact History to new database.
 - Provide web-based interactive screens to insert, delete and update records.
 - Provide secure multiuser access to Contact History.
2. Capture and maintain Kid's Connection data.
 - Participation history, grade history.
 - Volunteer information.
3. Capture and maintain Conference data.
 - Conference marketing.
 - Participation history of TMC Stakeholders
4. Capture and maintain Donor List data.
5. Ability to export data to GIS support system in standard format.
 - Ability to store maps created by GIS system.
 - Display stored maps online in interactive form.
6. Capture and maintain Resource data.
 - Allow external entities to add their website URLs to database.
 - Display added URLs in Resource Links page.
7. Ability to export data to OHATS system in standard format.
8. Capture and maintain TMC Survey data, Guest book entries and Feedback information. *From multiple web sites*
9. Capture and maintain Event data.
 - Golf Benefits, Recruitment Campaigns.
 - Fundraising events linked to Donor data.

*• Conferences
• student/volunteer
• program
• TMC - web*

10. Capture and maintain Email List data for marketing.

11. *Set up* Organize for bulk mailings of invitations, newsletters, etc. *VIA email or standard US mail*

2.1.1.1 Key features of the system.

Key features that support interaction with TMC network can be summarized as follows:

- Comprehensive Search capability to find information stored in system.
- Ability to display pre-formatted reports.
- Ability to create individual reports for each user.
- Provide interactive data analysis tools – graphs, pie and bar charts. — *GIS*
- Provide interactive ability to run "What If" scenarios. — *via GIS*
- System level security with access control in various levels.
 - Level 1 access to TMC System Administrators.
 - Level 2 access to TMC users/participants.

- Level 3 access to external customers.
- User friendly and design for speed. Cater to different categories of external customers:
 - Leaders of single programs, networks and community groups.
 - Philanthropy foundation leaders.
 - Media, Researchers
 - Business Leaders
 - Political Leaders – Local, State, National.
- Flexible design for future growth.

2.2 Constraints/Issues

1. Availability of dedicated developer resources.
2. Availability of development environment and tools.
3. Location of development.
4. A plan to adequately support new system once in place.

2.3 Recommendation

Plan Phase Estimates:

Target dates and cost for the Plan Phase are as follows:

Project Phase/Stage	Hours	Cost	Start – End Dates
Plan Phase Total	0	0	08/01/01 –
Requirements	0	0	
Engineer Approach	0	0	
Plan the Project	0	0	

Forecasted Project Schedule (through completion)	
Milestone	Target End Date Range
Design Stage	
Construction Stage	
Test Stage	
Deployment Stage	
Post-Implementation Stage	

Note: Forecasted dates are a best guess of the effort required to deliver based on high-level requirements. Since not all facts and requirements have been identified and designed, it is not possible to commit to specific dates at this stage of the project. The Project Execution dates are based on the preliminary schedule provided by the vendor.

3. PROJECT ORGANIZATION

3.1 Assigning Resources

The following table was used as a worksheet to determine the hierarchy of named individuals appointed as: Project Board, , Project/ Stage Manager(s), Project Coordinators, Key Resources, Project Team, and Key Stakeholders.

Role	Responsibilities	Resource	Coordination Procedure	Time Req'd
<i>Project Board</i>	- Expenditures - Resolution of issues - Go/No go - Ensure success - Approve scope		Meeting with minutes	Varies
<i>Project Sponsor</i>	- Chairs the board and funds the project - Represents project to the rest of the organization		Meeting with minutes	Bi-monthly
<i>Technical Representative</i>	- Allocates business resources to the project team - Ensures that the project's results will work in the operational level of the business.			
	- Ensures that the technical deliverables of the project are consistent with the overall technical strategy of the corporation. - Allocates technical resources to the project team.		Individual status report	Weekly
<i>Project/Stage Manager</i>	- Day to day management - Responsible for the planning and administrative aspects of the project. - Production of end of stage deliverables. - Reporting and scheduling. - Brings issues to the board.	Shriram Venkatraman	Project Status Report	Weekly
<i>Project Team</i>	Do the actual work on the project	TBD		Varies
<i>Technical Team</i>	Produce the technical deliverables	TBD		

<i>Business</i>	- Ensures that the operational interests of the business are being fully represented in the day-to-day operations of the project. - Helps identify who from the business areas can add value to the project team.			
<i>Technical</i>	- Helps ensure the technical quality of the deliverables being produced. - Assists in identifying all the technical tasks and standards that need to be followed. - Identifies resources to facilitate the production of project deliverables.		Individual status report	Weekly
<i>Key Resources</i>	- Provide expert knowledge in specific business or technical areas. - Contribute to the creation of stage deliverables by providing information - May also review stage deliverables.			
<i>Technical Support</i>	- Make sure the system is up and running - Installations			
<i>Process Coordinator</i>	- Ensure quality of the technical deliverables produced - Assists in identifying all of the technical tasks and standards that need to be followed.			
<i>GUI Standards</i>	Provides expert knowledge of good GUI design practices and organizational GUI standards.			
<i>Quality Assurance</i>	Ensure quality of project deliverables during specific stages and phases of the project			
<i>Key Stakeholders</i>	Receive major deliverables produced during a stage of the project.			

3.2 Project Organization Chart

Considering the Project Organization Worksheet, the following chart is produced.
</flowchart>

3.3 Project phases

Major phases and activities of the project will consist of the activities below:

Feasibility – the project goals, benefits and objectives will be defined. Typically, efforts are intended to surface high-level requirements needed to satisfy both objectives. Analysis of current practices is conducted to acquire an understanding of critical processes. Areas of improvement identified. At this time, requirements necessary for the day-to-day operations, as well as requirements necessary for future growth and continuity identified. Prioritization of requirements performed to distinguish the “must have” requirements from the “nice to have” requirements.

Planning – The planning phase will include engineering the approach for implementation of approved software solution. Activities such as the completion of the Requirements document and project plan will be conducted.

Execution – Because the tasks within the Execution Phase will vary depending upon the decision made in the Planning Phase, details for this phase will be provided later. At this time, it is sufficient to state detailed task list will be written for the successful implementation of the system. It is also necessary to state that design, construction, testing and implementation of this project will comply with the standard development process as identified.

4. SCHEDULES AND BUDGET

4.1 Schedules

Milestone Descriptions and Dates from the *overall Project Schedule* are described below.

Overview of Project Schedule		
Milestone	Start/End Dates	Status
Conduct current system analysis		
Gather Requirements		
Create Project Initiation Doc		
Project Initiation Signoff		
Select technical solution		
Create Requirements Document		
Engineer the Approach		
Execution Planning		
Determine Det Sizing Estimates		
Determine Resource Reqs		
Develop Implementation Approach / Timeline		
Develop Execution Workplan		
Detailed Design		
Construction		
Testing		
Deployment		
Post Production Support		

Note: Project Execution dates are based on the preliminary schedule provided by the vendor. Since not all facts and requirements have been identified and designed, it is not possible to commit to specific dates at this stage of the project. Forecasted dates are a best guess of the effort required to deliver based on high-level requirements.

4.1.1 Assumptions

Resource availability

As the project evolves, additional resources are necessary for project responsibilities, test planning and coordination, construction and technical integration.

Project Initiation Approval

The project sponsors must approve this Initiation Report in order for the TMC CDIS Development team to proceed to the next phase. The Project Board may recommend some changes to the Project Initiation Report. These changes will be reflected in an updated Project Initiation Report or as an amendment to the Project Initiation Report to ensure accurate communication of the plan to all project team members.

4.2 Overall Project Cost Analysis and Cost Curve

The following worksheet show the cost estimates for the a development solution. Additional cost estimates will be provided when needed. Should TMC Project Board decide not to go with the recommended solution, the project costs will need to be modified.

Project Phase	Hours	Cost of Effort
Feasibility	400	10000
Planning (estimate)	450	25000
Execute (forecast)	900	20000
Best Guess Total		55000

Note: Time and cost are a best guess of the effort required to deliver based on high-level requirements. Since not all facts and requirements have been identified and designed, it is not possible to commit to specific dates at this stage of the project.

4.3 Project Budget

5. BUSINESS CASE

5.1 Project Description

Scope	The scope of this project includes all activities necessary to define and implement a solution that will meet the requirements of TMC network
Objectives	To define and implement a system for the TMC network: • To deliver a system that functionally meets the business requirements • Deliver a fully supportable system that complies with the approved technical architecture.
Timescale	Initiation Phase – Planning Phase – Execution Phase -

5.2 Benefit Analysis

Tangible Benefits		
Benefit	Value	Assumption

Intangible Benefits	
Benefit	Assumption

Strategic Benefits (providing information that was not previously available)	
Benefit	Assumption

5.3 Cost/Benefit Analysis

	2002 Year 0	2003 Year 1	2004 Year 2	2005 Year 3	2006 Year 5	Total
Outflows						
Software Licensing						
Hardware						
Development						
Functional Customization*						
New System Maint & Support						
Training						
Database License						
Miscellaneous						
Total Outflows						
Inflows						
Increase Revenue						
Total Inflows						
Difference (Non-Discounted)						
Incremental Present Value						
Net Present Value by Year						

**Functional Customization – this estimated cost may change upon the vendor's review of detailed specifications.*

Appendix A - Communication/Training Plan

A.1 Communication Plan

The Communication Plan defines the process of disseminating information among the project team members and management. Special delivery mechanisms will be utilized to effectively communicate information relative to the TMC Network CDIS project. The following table outlines these mechanisms:

Delivery Mechanism	Objective/Approach	Facilitator	Frequency
Project Status IT Meeting	- Review general project status - Provide task updates - Review milestones - Review issues	Project Manager	Weekly
Working session	- Information gathering - Requirements definitions - Systems analysis - Issue identification and resolution	Project Management Team	As required
Yahoo Groups system	- General dissemination of information - Delivery of documentation and status reports	Project Manager	As required
Design walk through	- Review technical deliverables for quality and accuracy - Ensure development standards	Technical Lead	As required
Project Status Report	- Accomplishments - Upcoming activities - General status – deliverables, issues, milestones	Project Manager	Weekly
Ad Hoc Meetings	- Issue management - Information gathering	As determined	As required

A.2 Training Plan

A comprehensive 'train the trainer' approach will be conducted. Individuals involved in the User Acceptance Testing (UAT) phase will be trained in all areas of the system, or those areas relevant to their respective line of business. This will be the most efficient manner to transfer a permanent and meaningful knowledge base to the business unit at the lowest cost to the firm.

Appendix B - Issues Management

B.1 Issue Tracking

The objective of Issue Management is to provide a process for collecting, escalating, tracking and resolving issues in order to facilitate the successful completion of the TMC CDIS project. To that end, a central repository for all project issues will be constructed and maintained for the duration of the project. Depending on priority, identified issues will be assigned for resolution with defined target resolution dates. Issues will be logged on an "as- needed" basis and will include the following:

- Issues with overall project impact
- Issues which may impact project milestones or deliverable completion dates
- Issues requiring business decisions
- Issues related to external projects or interface partners
- Issues requiring project management attention or escalation

Each week all issues will be reported and reviewed during the weekly Project Status Meeting.

B.2 Issue Tracking System

The Project Management Team will be responsible for maintaining the Issue Tracking System. The following table outlines the fields identified to accurately track the issues:

Field	Description
Issue Number	Sequential identifier of issues. The issue number will be generated once the issue is saved.
Issue Title*	Brief title of the issue
Date Reported	Date issue was reported
Reported by	Name of person reporting the issue
Severity*	Critical: potential to impact the progression of the entire project; management escalation required High: high priority issue, potential impact on team or project milestones, requires management visibility or escalation Medium: issue needs to be addressed, isolated impact on overall project Low: issues can be addressed during the normal course of the project
Issue Type*	Business Issue: requires specific decision/intervention Technical Issue: requires specific decision/intervention Project Mgmt Issue: overall project or project management issue Data Mapping Issue: requires decision/intervention Other: Undefined issue category Scope/Requirement Change: Requires Steering committee approval
Issue Status*	New: all issues default to "New" when entered in the database; once reviewed in the weekly team lead meeting, they will be moved to "Open" status. Updates from the weekly review meeting will be made by Project Management Support. Open/In analysis: issues which are open and being analyzed for possible resolutions Open/Pending decision: issues which analysis is complete and a resolution has been proposed Closed: issues which have been resolved and closed Re-opened: issue was resolved, however, was re-opened, may have an

Field	Description
	ongoing Impact.
Description	Detailed description of the issue
Status update date	Date the last status report was given
Assigned to	Individual responsible for addressing/researching the issue
Resolve By	Target date for issue resolution
Update/ Resolution	Detailed issue update information (running commentary of issue status)
Update Last Chgd	Date the issue was last updated. This field is populated with the current date, located at the bottom of the issue form.
Date Closed	Date issue was closed

Appendix C - Change Management Process

C.1 Overview and Objectives

The objective of Change Management is to identify and define potential additions to project scope in terms of impact, and requirements. The process will facilitate providing project team members with the decision criteria needed to approve/deny items in a timely manner based on the cross-functional risks, benefits, and impacts.

The Change Management process is intended to manage all new additions to conversion, system modification, or testing scope as a result of revised approaches, new requirements, or additional gap items discovered. The overall objective of the process is to ensure all impacts of additional scope items have been identified, weighed, and communicated prior to committing to the additional scope.

C.2 Tool

The Issue Tracking System will serve as a repository for all change requests. Change requests will be noted using the Issue Type field.

C.3 Process

- Enter all applicable information in the Issue Tracking System.
- All new scope management/change requests will be reviewed each week in the Project Status Meeting. Here they will be assigned for further analysis (if necessary) or escalated to other escalation points.
- The target resolution date will be used to ensure that change requests are submitted for timely review and decisions.
- Change requests should be logged as soon as they have been identified, even if all downstream impacts and estimates have not been confirmed. This allows for management visibility prior to any effort being applied to research the particular scope/change request.
- The Project Status Meeting will be used to review and communicate decisions made on outstanding scope management/change requests. An updated list of outstanding and recently approved/denied requests will be prepared for each Project Status Meeting.

Appendix D - Quality Management Approach

D.1 Planned Activities

- Quality Assurance (QA) Reviews will be conducted, at a minimum, for each of the four (4) following project phases. The QA Review will entail the review of project phase deliverables, as well as other related documentation. The QA organization will be actively involved in these stages of the project.
 - Feasibility Phase
 - Plan Phase
 - Pre-Implementation Phase
 - Post-Implementation Phase
- All stage deliverables to be included in the review. (The deliverable required at the time of review is depends on the phase of the project).
 - Project Definition
 - Project Initiation
 - Project Requirements
 - Engineer Project Approach
 - Plan the Project
 - Design
 - Construction
 - Test
 - Pre-Implementation
 - Implementation
 - Post-Implementation